

Meet Pat Summitt: Introduction Featuring Peyton Manning

Peyton Manning, 2021 Pro Football Hall of Fame Inductee & Super Bowl Champion

Hi, everyone. Peyton Manning, here. I'm thrilled that all of you are here today to hear the words of wisdom put forth by my dear friend, Pat Summitt. Pat was not just an iconic basketball coach. She was a trailblazer for women, a champion for gender equality, and an amazing educator who graduated 100 percent of her student-athletes at the University of Tennessee.

Pat was clearly an American treasure. She used to say, 'Nobody cares how much you know until they know how much you care.' Pat's caring attitude motivated her to create a formula for success and leadership in life called the **Definite Dozen**. These principles were the foundation of her programs for decades.

Narrator

Pat Summitt was a leadership and coaching superstar. Her stats alone are the stuff of legend. 1,098 wins, 16 SEC titles, eight national championships, eight-time SEC coach of the year, seven-time NCAA coach of the year, Naismith coach of the century in 2000, and one of *The Sporting News*' 50 greatest coaches of all time.

Pat Summitt's career was nothing short of spectacular, but her stats, as extraordinary as they are, only tell part of the story. Pat Summitt's influence extends beyond the court to the lives she impacted and the lessons she left behind for achieving greatness.

This is the story of a farm girl who fell in love with basketball and grew up to change the world of sports forever. Pat's coaching tree continues to make an impact on the game today. Her influence has left an indelible impression on the entire sporting world.

Pat Summitt always demanded the best from others and held herself to the same standard. When she was diagnosed with early onset dementia Alzheimer's type in 2011, Pat faced it head on and decided to keep coaching. She stayed in the public eye while dealing with a crippling disease and displayed the sort of courage and resilience that mark a true leader.

Those who tuned in for what many assumed would be Pat's last season saw a woman bolstered by the tremendous support from the community she had cultivated at Tennessee. True to form, Coach Summitt kept on fighting and led her team to their 16th SEC championship. It would be the last time she performed the champion's ritual of cutting down the basketball after the game.

A few weeks later, Pat Summitt decided it was time to move on from the great passion of her life. In 2012, she retired from her position as head coach of the Lady Vols and was named head

coach emeritus. That same year, she was awarded the Presidential Medal of Freedom and the Arthur Ashe Courage Award.

Even as she stepped away from the spotlight Pat never admitted defeat. Instead, she shifted her focus to the fight against Alzheimer's. Shortly after her diagnosis, Pat and her son Tyler created the Pat Summitt Foundation, an organization for awarding grants to nonprofits dedicated to advancing research into treatment and a cure for Alzheimer's. Pat Summitt was in attendance when in January 2015 the University of Tennessee Medical Center and the Pat Summitt Foundation announced a partnership to build the Pat Summitt Clinic for furthering treatment capabilities, research initiatives, and family support for Alzheimer's and other dementias. Sadly, Pat would not live to see the clinic's opening in 2017. She passed away at the age of 64 on June 28, 2016.

Shortly after her death, the Pat Summitt Leadership Group was formed to spread the words and teachings of Pat Summitt, using film, educational programs, and publishing, the Pat Summitt Leadership Group uses the core principles of Pat's **Definite Dozen** to help leaders of all ages find personal and professional success.

Pat's influence lives on with every life that continues to be impacted by the enduring wisdom of her leadership philosophy and practice. Pat Summitt was more than a coach. She was a role model, a lifelong teacher, and a sterling example of courage and leadership.

Her legacy is that of being the most successful coach in the history of women's basketball, but she lived a life that goes beyond stellar statistics. It's a life filled with lessons for what it looks like to win with people and leave the world a better place because of it.